CINEMA

MAKING OF A MYSTERYVERSE

Filmmaker **Srijit Mukherji** just released a thriller for the movie theatres and a detective OTT series, and is plotting a Bangla cop universe







IN TOP FORM
Jisshu Sengupta (left) in *Dawshom Awbotaar* and (top) a still from *Durgo Rawhosyo*; (inset) Srijit Mukherji

Q. Are you in a celebratory mood after your film became India's official Oscar 2024 entry?
Not at all. I'm in a responsible mood and preparing for my next film. I will celebrate only after winning the Oscar. I never expected *2018* to become India's official entry. I made the film from the experiences of the people who suffered during the 2018 floods. I was myself a victim. Living in Athani, near Kochi airport, I had to shift my family to my sister's home. During the flood days, I experienced the uncertainty of the people as the situation was alarming. My experiences coupled with the trauma experienced by others prompted me to make the film.

Q. There was criticism that you minimised and misdirected the role of the government during the 2018 floods.
I did not set out to make a documentary about the 2018 floods. It's just a film to entertain people

CINEMA/INTERVIEW

"IT'S A DREAM"

Jude Anthany Joseph, 40, has become a national sensation after his latest film, *2018*, featuring Kerala's mega floods, was nominated as India's official entry for the 2024 Oscars. Joseph, who studied engineering, has pursued cinema as his passion and also acted in movies during his decade in Malayalam cinema. He has made three films before this: the hit *Ohm Shanthi Oshaana* (2014), *Oru Muthassi Gadha* (2016) and the OTT-release *Sara's* (2021). Being witness to the 2018 floods inspired Joseph to make a film rooted in reality. The film's cast includes Tovino Thomas, Aparna Balamurali, Tanvi Ram, Kunchacko Boban, Asif Ali, Vineeth Sreenivasan, Narain and Lal. Joseph speaks to INDIA TODAY about his film's selection as India's official Oscar entry.

